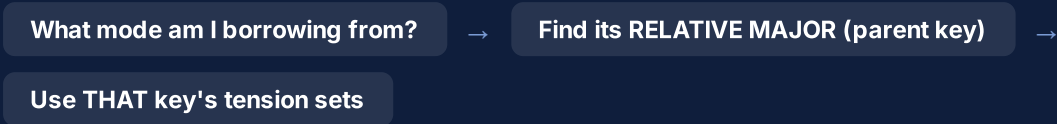


MI TENSION SYSTEM

Modal interchange chords don't need a new tension set — use parent-key logic instead.

THE PARENT-KEY RULE



WALKTHROUGH — BORROWING FROM C MINOR (PARALLEL MINOR OF C)

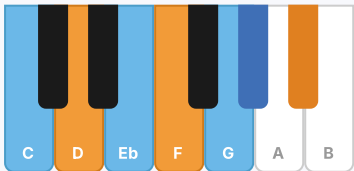
- BORROWING FROM:** Parallel minor of C = **C minor**
- PARENT KEY:** Relative major of C minor = **E♭ major** (3 flats)
- THEREFORE:** Use **E♭ major's tension sets** for all borrowed chords
- EXAMPLE 1:** **A♭maj7 (bVI maj7 in C)** = IVmaj7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, #11, 13
- EXAMPLE 2:** **Fm7 (iv-7 in C)** = ii-7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, 11
- EXAMPLE 3:** **B♭7 (bVII7 in C)** = V7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, 13

PARENT KEY REFERENCE — MOST COMMON MI SOURCES

MODE BORROWED	PARENT KEY	EXAMPLE CHORD IN C	PARENT FUNCTION	AVAILABLE TENSIONS
Parallel Minor	E♭ major	A♭maj7 (bVI maj7)	IVmaj7 in E♭	9 #11 13
Parallel Minor	E♭ major	Fm7 (iv-7)	ii-7 in E♭	9 11
Parallel Minor	E♭ major	B♭7 (bVII7)	V7 in E♭	9 13
Parallel Minor	E♭ major	E♭maj7 (bIII maj7)	I maj7 in E♭	9 13
Lydian	C major	D7 (II7)	V7/V in C	9 13
Mixolydian	F major	B♭ (bVII)	IVmaj7 in F	9 #11 13
Phrygian	A♭ major	D♭maj7 (bII)	IVmaj7 in A♭	9 #11 13

A♭maj7 in C major — Tensions from E♭ major (IVmaj7 logic)

3rd #11 5th 13 7 Root 9th Available tensions: B♭ (9), D (nat13 / #11), F (13)



Root (A♭) Chord Tones Available Tensions (9, #11, 13)

This logic works for ALL modes — just find the relative major (parent key) and look up what function the borrowed chord performs there. The whole-step rule still applies within the parent key. You never need to memorize a new tension set for modal interchange.